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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Qualified Paralegal role at Pilgrim's Europe appeals to me because the work sits at the intersection of commercial contracts, procurement and technology law across a sizeable in-house operation, and my background preparing and reviewing transactional documents, managing competing deadlines and advising on legal risk in commercial contexts maps closely onto what the role requires.

At Adobe I spent a summer reviewing and amending software licensing agreements, assessing data-processing provisions against UK and EU GDPR requirements, and coordinating with sales and international business teams to reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk. That work gave me a grounding in commercial contracts that goes beyond theory: I had to read provisions carefully, identify where they exposed the business to risk, and communicate amendments clearly to non-lawyers. An in-house team supporting procurement and technology matters across multiple brands involves exactly that kind of judgment at volume, and I am confident I can contribute from an early stage.

At BCLP I spent six months in the Real Estate Disputes team managing large volumes of confidential documents across several matters running simultaneously, tracking deadlines, preparing court bundles and assisting with filings. For the six months prior I supported a complex investment arbitration, became the only junior on the team shortly before a major submission deadline, and coordinated documents and outstanding actions across multiple contributors to ensure on-time delivery. A partner and associate gave feedback that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. Both placements built habits around organisation and deadline management that translate directly into supporting a busy commercial legal function.

My current role at Citizens Advice East Berkshire involves managing matters end to end: taking detailed instructions, identifying legal issues, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential case records. Working with clients on welfare, employment and housing matters has also sharpened my ability to translate complex legal requirements into practical guidance quickly, which I imagine is just as relevant when advising internal business stakeholders as it is with individual clients.

Pilgrim's Europe's scale and the breadth of brands in the portfolio mean the legal team is dealing with varied commercial questions under real business pressure. That is the kind of environment where I want to develop my in-house experience, and the commercial and procurement focus of this role is a genuine next step from the contract-review and risk-identification work I have already done.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva